

Unlearning Racism: Becoming Antiracist

Recognizing your biases and moving to antiracism

4 lenses · tips & action steps — by EvaTalk

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BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Recognizing your biases and moving to antiracism

You can be 'not racist' in intention and still hold biases, benefit from privileges, or stay passive in the face of racism. Being antiracist isn't an achieved state: it's active, ongoing work.

This guide helps you recognize your biases and move from 'non-racist' to actively antiracist.

Your intention

A situation where you realized a bias, a privilege, or passivity in the face of racism: _____

The 4 approaches

This guide works your topic through 4 complementary psychology lenses. Read, do the exercises, fill the workbook — at your own pace.

Psychodynamic — understand the root.

CBT — ease the negative thoughts.

Humanistic — reconcile with yourself.

Systemic — act on your environment.

Systemic racism, internalized bias

Racism isn't only the deliberate slur: it's also a system (unequal access, representation, safety) and implicit biases we all carry. 'I'm not racist' isn't enough.

Understanding this moves you from defense to responsibility.

Example

Sure he was 'neutral', Marc found very real implicit biases by observing himself honestly. It set him in motion.

My privileges / blind spots

What advantages tied to your background have you never had to question?

Non-racist ≠ antiracist

Write the difference, for you, between 'not being racist' and 'acting against racism'.

→ *Racism is systemic and internalized — my responsibility goes beyond 'I'm not racist'.*

Seeing your own automatics

Implicit biases, unintended microaggressions, 'I don't see color' (which erases lived experience), tokenism, defensiveness the moment the topic comes up: all signals to spot.

Here too: impact matters more than intention.

Example

Hearing herself say 'I don't see color', Claire understood she was erasing what others really lived. She shifted her stance.

My automatics

Note 2 reflexes (thought, word, defensive reaction) that reflect a bias.

Impact, not intent

For one of them: what impact could it have had, whatever your intention?

→ *I see my automatics — without hiding in 'I'm not racist'.*

Aligning actions with equality

If you say you value equality, deconstruction is proving it: listening to affected people, believing their experience, decentering yourself — your discomfort isn't the point.

Active empathy beats paralyzing guilt.

Example

Rather than justify herself, Sophie went quiet and listened to a colleague's account. She learned more in ten minutes than in ten years of passive 'goodwill'.

My values/actions gap

Where do your actions not yet match the equality you claim to value?

Decentering myself

Write: 'My discomfort isn't the point — the point is the impact on affected people.'

→ *I prove my values by listening and decentering.*

Moving to active antiracism

Concretely: educate yourself (don't make affected people do this work), interrupt racism, share space and power, support, vote, repair when you harm, and welcome feedback as a gift.

Antiracism is lived in action — repeated, over time.

Example

Instead of staying quiet 'to avoid making waves', Hugo flagged a discriminatory practice in his team. It cost a little — and changed something.

My action

A concrete antiracist action this week (interrupt, support, share space, repair): _____

Feedback as a gift

Write: 'Feedback on my racism is a chance to grow, not an attack.'

→ *I move from non-racist to antiracist — in action, over time.*

Practical tips & advice

Tips & advice

- Passive 'non-racist' ≠ active antiracist.
- Everyone has implicit biases — the point is to see them and act.
- Impact > intention: if you harm, listen instead of defending yourself.
- Educate yourself (don't make affected people do this work).
- Decenter yourself: your discomfort isn't the point.
- Take action (interrupt, support, share space, repair) — it's lifelong work.

To fill in

My biases & blind spots

The reflex / privilege	Its possible impact

My antiracist actions

Concrete action	When

PLAN

Your 4-week plan

Week 1 — Understand systemic racism & internalized bias.

Week 2 — Spot my automatics (impact > intention).

Week 3 — Listen & decenter myself.

Week 4 — Act: interrupt, support, repair.

Your plan in 3 lines

- The blind spot I'm working on:
- The source I educate myself with:
- My first antiracist action:

TO CLOSE

Being antiracist isn't a state — it's active, ongoing, necessary work.

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This guide is a reflection and psychoeducation tool for deconstructing your own biases — not therapy. Deconstruction is ongoing work: discomfort is part of the path, but the goal remains real impact on the people affected, not your comfort. ©

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